

Incident Report (Notes)

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DATE: June 01, 2025

Incident Overview

Fill in the missing information using the two PCAPs and the SIEM.

SCOPE	Targeted Device's IP:		[LAB-HOST-A]	Responds to HTTP requests for /wp-login.php with 200 OK responses. Example: Packet 1835 – [LAB-HOST-A] → [LAB-HOST-B]	1a
	Malicious Device's IP:		[LAB-HOST-B]	Initiates a high volume of HTTP GET requests to /wp-login.php in rapid succession. Example: Packet 1800 – [LAB-HOST-B] → [LAB-HOST-A]	1b
	Targeted Service:		WordPress 6.7.2	The URI /wp-login.php is the default login page for WordPress. Repeated HTTP requests confirm WordPress as the target. Response contains WordPress stylesheet and script references with ver=6.7.2	1c
	Targeted URI:		/wp-login.php	Observed in repeated HTTP GET requests sent by [LAB-HOST-B] Example: Packets 1800–1821 all target /wp-login.php	1d
	User-agent string associated with malicious activity:		Mozilla/5.0 (Hydra)	Found in the HTTP request headers sent by [LAB-HOST-B] Line: User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Hydra)	1e
IMPACT	Credentials exposed (admin):	Username	admin	Packet # -9809	2a
		Password		TCP stream shows attacker logging in with admin / and receiving a 302 redirect to /wp-admin.	2b
	Credentials exposed (regular):	Username	elliott	8267, 16958, 25505, 34520	2c
		Password		WordPress login form at /wp-login.php	2d
TIMESTAMPS (UTC)	Timerange of attack1.pcap	Begin	2025-04-10 9:45:55	Packet #1	3a
		End	2025-04-10 09:49:05	Packet # 10959	3b
	Timerange of attack2.pcap	Begin	2025-04-10 09:41:26	Packet# 1	3c
		End	2025-04-10 09:44:11	Packet# 36285	3d
	Timerange of actual attack	Begin	2025-04-10 09:42:22	Packet# 674	3e
		End	2025-04-10 09:48:41	Packet# 10694	3f
	Total duration of attack		6mins and 19seconds	Take 3f and subtract it from 3e to determine the total duration of the attack.	3g

	Successful authentication events	1st (admin)	302 Found response and session cookies issued confirm successful login.	/wp-admin/	4a
	(delete any additional rows below this that you don't need for this incident)	2nd (elliott)	I		4b
		3rd (username)			4c
		4th (username)			4d
		5th (username)			4e
		6th (username)			4f
		7th (username)			4g
		8th (username)			4h

Timeline

Document the major events in the timeline.

T6a	2025-04-10 15:48:41.000000 UTC	9749	Authentication event (REQUEST)	Attacker submits auth form using admin / port 80 from to to	attack1... Found using display filter: http.response.code == 302
T6b	2025-04-10 15:48:41.003212 UTC	9809	Authentication event (RESPONSE)	Web server accepts login, issues 302 redirect to /wp-admin/ – confirms successful authentication as user admin.	attack1... Filtered on http.response.code == 302, followed TCP stream
T7a	2025-04-10 15:42:28.000000 UTC	8267	Authentication event (REQUEST)	Attacker submits auth form using elliott / c5G)!#780j!yG!um3y 5YRVf5 to port 80 from to	attack2 Found using display filter: http.response.code == 302

				[LAB-HOST-A] attack2.pcap		
T7b	2025-04-10 15:42:28.003212 UTC	8446	Authentication event (RESPONSE)	Web server accepts login, issues 302 redirect to /wp-admin/ – confirms successful authentication as user elliot.	attack2... ▾	Filtered on http.response.code == 302, followed TCP stream
T8a	2025-04-10 15:42:37.000000 UTC	16958	Authentication event (REQUEST)	Attacker submits auth form using elliot / c5G)l#780jlyG!um3y 5YRVf5 to port 80 from [LAB-HOST-B] to [LAB-HOST-A]	attack2... ▾	Found using display filter: http.response.code == 302
T8b	2025-04-10 15:42:37.003212 UTC	17040	Authentication event (RESPONSE)	Web server accepts login, issues 302 redirect to /wp-admin/ – confirms successful authentication as user elliot.	attack2... ▾	Filtered on http.response.code == 302, followed TCP stream
T9a	2025-04-10 15:42:47.000000 UTC	25505	Authentication event (REQUEST)	Attacker submits auth form using elliot / c5G)l#780jlyG!um3y 5YRVf5 to port 80 from [LAB-HOST-B] to [LAB-HOST-A]	attack2... ▾	Found using display filter: http.response.code == 302
T9b	2025-04-10 15:42:47.003212 UTC	25948	Authentication event (RESPONSE)	Web server accepts login, issues 302 redirect to /wp-admin/ – confirms successful authentication as user elliot.	attack2... ▾	Filtered on http.response.code == 302, followed TCP stream
T10a	2025-04-10 15:42:56.000000 UTC	34520	Authentication event (REQUEST)	Attacker submits auth form using elliot / c5G)l#780jlyG!um3y 5YRVf5 to port 80 from [LAB-HOST-B] to [LAB-HOST-A]	attack2... ▾	Found using display filter: http.response.code == 302
T10b	2025-04-10 15:42:56.003212 UTC	34575	Authentication event (RESPONSE)	Web server accepts login, issues 302 redirect to /wp-admin/ –	attack2... ▾	Filtered on http.response.code == 302, followed TCP stream

				confirms successful authentication as user elliot.		
					Choose... ▾	
					Choose... ▾	

Conclusion

This investigation identified a brute force attack targeting the WordPress login portal at /wp-login.php. Network analysis confirmed that the host [LAB-HOST-B] initiated repeated authentication attempts against the web server [LAB-HOST-A] using the Hydra tool, identified through the HTTP User-Agent header. Packet analysis confirmed successful credential submission attempts involving the accounts admin and elliot. The activity occurred within a short time window and demonstrated automated credential testing behavior consistent with brute force techniques.